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THE REVOLUTIONARY BHOODAN YAGNA

A

Collection of speeches

BY

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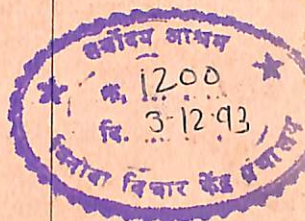
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The Bhoodan-Yagna of Acharya Vinoba Bhave had its inspired origin in Pochampalli village in Hyderabad on 18th April 1951 during his walking tour. The movement has made marvellous progress during the last 3½ years. The total land gift received till December 1954 has exceeded 35 lakhs of acres all over India.

The Bhoodan-Yagna as the first step towards the Sarvodaya ideal of a New Social Order, has appealed to the genius of the Nation and its eminent leaders.

Here is a collection of some of their speeches expounding the basic principles and the philosophy underlying the Bhoodan-Yagna from various angles.

‘JEEVAN-DAN’ by Shri Jaiprakash Narain was the first of this series of cheap booklets. And this is the second. The next number will contain selected extracts from the speeches of Vinobaji.

Tanjore }
Jan. 1955 }

Sarvodaya Prachuralayam
of Akhila BHARAT SARVA SEVA SANGH

BHOODAN - THE ECONOMIC AGRARIAN REVOLUTION

S-2-57

DR. S. RADHAKRISHNAN

ACHARYAJI started his discourse with a vedic prayer * that we may all grow one in mind, one in heart, one in purpose. That is the prayer with which he started his discourse this evening. We have had this prayer coming down to us for centuries. We cannot say that we have developed unity of mind, heart or purpose. While the ideal which we held before us commanded our allegiance intellectually, in practice we have deviated from it. If the success of our civilisation is due to the dominance of this ideal the failure of our civilisation is due to the departure from these ideals. It is true that we have survived—survived many other civilisations which have passed away. If you want to understand those other civilisations you have to study really the ruins where jackals howl in the moonlight. But so far as Indian civilisation is concerned, the very fact that we have an assembly like this and a number of distinguished exponents of Indian culture brought together on the day, it makes you feel that the culture is alive.

* Samani Vah Akutihi Samana Hridayani Vah

Samanamsthu Vo Mano Yadha Vah Susahasati

Acharyaji has started this Bhoodan Yagna. There are many people who think that in our country we want salvation or *mukti*, and every individual high or low, caste or outcast, has the liberty to attain Nirvan. But Nirvan does not mean liberation from the body. One of the Upanishads tells you: "Pranaramam Manaanandam, Santhi Samrudham, Amrutham".

"Amrita" or life eternal is "Pranaramam", the play of physical light, "Mana Anandam", satisfaction of the mind, "Shanti Samrudham", the tranquillity of spirit. Therefore, life eternal means an all-round awakening, a Sarvodaya, so to say, of all the powers of the human being. It is an all-round development of the human being. "Pranaramam" is the first thing, the play of the vital organism, the play of light. Body is not a thing to be neglected. It is a thing to be cultivated. When the Yoga Sutra Acharya tells us how we are to attain Samadhi the first condition he puts is 'Develop your physique'. He points out to us: 'rupa — lavanya — bala — vajra Samhananathvani Kayasampat'.

"The physical prowess consists in the development of beauty, of radiance, of strength, of invulnerability". Unless you develop your physical basis nothing else is possible for you. You cannot have intellectual development or spiritual development unless you provide for the material basis of life.

Bhoodan, in trying to bring about an economic agrarian revolution by enabling all our individuals, all the citizens who are engaged in agriculture, to share some land which they can use for their purposes, is

attempting to provide for this very essential basis of any other kind of development. Aristotle also says :

“We must live before we can live well and life means the provision of the material necessities”.

I may incidentally point out that this agrarian revolution will also help to eliminate the differences of caste and outcast, which are polluting, corrupting, so to say, our atmosphere. There is no one who can get up and say that the observance of these distinctions is in accordance with religion, or social morality. If religion tells us one thing it is this. Here, in this place, Bodh-Gaya, we have to remember what both the Hindu, the Buddhist and the Jaina scriptures have declared. The Hindu scripture says “*Thathvamasi*”, “That art thou”. Each human individual has the spark of the Divine. It does not say, only the Brahmin has the spark divine, or the outcast has it, or the rich has it, or the poor has it. It says all men by virtue of their humanity have the possibilities of growing into the divine stature. The Divine is there stationed as a possibility in every human being. The Buddha told us that everyone can become a Buddha, can develop Bodhi or enlightenment. There is no one who is prevented from the realisation of that possibility. So also the Jains tell us that everyone can become *Arhata*. The Jews declared that the spirit of man is the candle of the Lord. Jesus tells us “The Kingdom of God is within you”.

St. Paul says: “Know ye not that you are the temple of God and the Spirit of God dwelleth in you”.

Islam proclaims that God is nearer to us than the very artery to our neck. Well, while all these religions with one voice are proclaiming the divine nature of the human being how can anyone get up and say that the practice of caste distinctions or the practice of untouchability are to be regarded as consistent with religion? It is opposed to religion, there is no doubt about it. Again turn to Ethics. What do you mean by Ethics? Ethics simply declare "*Paropakara*" is *punya*, and "*Parapeedana*" is *papa*. '*Parapeedana*' does not mean merely inflicting a bodily injury. Doing violence to the dignity of another human being is doing violence to him in the most tender part of his nature. He is a sacred being. He has his own dignity and anyone who offends by saying that these things are not to be provided for you, those other things are to be given for you, is practising something which is unethical.

And what does our social Dharma say? Dharma is that which binds society together or Adharma is that which breaks society asunder. Anything which makes for the consolidation of society is Dharma; anything which makes for the disintegration of society is Adharma. If in this human history of ours we have suffered many defeats, may I say that it is not suffering imposed on an innocent being, it is not a crucifixion that we have had, we have suffered for the sins we have committed.

There is such a thing as the logic of history. The world is bound by the law of Karma. Nations rise or fall according to their great qualities or their opposite. So, we must realise that if you practise anything which

leads to the decomposition or the disintegration of the society you are doing something which is Adharma. If you do anything which brings people together you are doing something which is Dharma. Dharma is that which makes for social coherence. Therefore, I ask, I plead with you, that if you are truly religious, if you are truly ethical, if you are believers in social morality, then practices like these will have to be eliminated. They bring this whole country and our religion into disgrace. No one can get up and say that these are the things which are furnished by our religions.

*(A speech delivered at the Sixth Sarvodaya
Sammelan at Bodh-Gaya on 19-4-1954)*



VINOBA AND HIS MISSION

BY

SURESH RAMABHAI

With a Foreward by Dr. S. Radhakrishnan
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FREEDOM OF THE INDIVIDUAL

DR. RAJENDRA PRASAD

TOTALITARIAN nations exercise control over human life at every step. Nations which do not accept totalitarianism are also tending to move in the direction of extending controls.

The view is expressed that we should get rid of administration in this country. Such views are also expressed in other countries. The view of the experts is that Government is best which governs least. Yet in all countries arming the administration with more and more powers is thought to be necessary.

We are seeing in this country that the control of the administration over the individual is growing. A proof of this is in the piling of laws passed by the legislatures and Parliament day by day. There seems to be no end to it.

The administration and some people believe that laws can solve all problems. We want laws to end the dowry system, to abolish the zamindaris and enable Harijans to enter temples.

We also want laws to safeguard the property attached to temples and to improve the relationship between workers and employers. We enact legislation to save ourselves from epidemics and disease. No one knows how much more legislation we want.

We are expanding the sphere of administration. It is not our fault. We are following the pattern of

administration in other countries. We have to think whether the administration should be of foreign pattern or in conformity with our own traditions. Is it something which should continue to remain? Why should we remain loaded with this burden if it is not necessary? Is there a way out?

If we want to save this country and make it really free, we have to consider the question whether the individual should rule himself or be ruled by others.

No country can do without the administration. It can be got rid of only when the individual rules himself properly and efficiently. Whether an individual should be governed by another individual or collectively by some individuals is a pertinent question. *I am glad to learn that the Sarvodaya Sammelan wants the individual to govern himself.*

We will then have a paradise on earth. It will not be easy to achieve. The climate to bring this about is being created through the propagation of Sarvodaya ideals. Instead of blaming the Government for its shortcoming, we should search our hearts and see how far we are responsible for them. When we think it over we will no longer be inclined to blame others. We can run our democracy successfully if we rid ourselves of our shortcomings.

*(From a speech delivered at the public meeting
at Bodh-Gaya on 18-4-54)*



PANDIT NEHRU ON BHOODAN

VINOBAJI has started the Bhoodan movement with the idea of getting land-gifts but the scope of it has been extended little by little. No doubt the movement has become a powerful factor in India today. Vinobaji has collected several millions of acres of land but what is really important is not the actual acreage but the new spirit that is infused in the minds of the people.

You should not expect the Bhoodan movement to solve the problem of the landless. That will be casting on you a responsibility which ought to be taken up by those who are in charge of the Government. But this movement has changed the atmosphere in India in regard to this question. Thereby, it has not only helped directly to solve the problem to some extent but indirectly it has induced the Government and others to attempt some satisfactory solution of this problem. This movement is revolutionary in its conception. Just as many of the things Gandhiji taught seemed simple but yet had a deep significance and great potentiality, so also this movement is remarkably simple to look at, yet it has far reaching consequences.

Acharya Vinoba Bhave is a person whom it is our great and good fortune to have amidst us and show us the way, should we err, and more particularly direct the people's minds and energies in the right direction. It is our good fortune to help him and others in this movement. The land problem or rather the problem of the landless cannot be solved by mere distribution

of land. Because there is not enough land. People have to be helped in other ways also to start industries.

You must be aware that the problem in India is essentially different from the problem in some other countries. Let us take Russia, for instance. It is different there because in Russia there are vast tracts of land and a limited number of people. Here there is a large number of people and the land is limited. We must follow the genius of the Indian people in solving these problems and follow Mahatma Gandhi because he knew exactly where the genius of India lay.

(From a speech inaugurating the Bhoodan Yagna workers' Camp at Kanjirapalli in Travancore State on 6-2-1954)



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THE BHOODAN MOVEMENT

Its origin and Philosophy

SHANKARRAO DEO

BHOODAN—A MIRACLE OF THE AGE

THE outside world has heralded the Bhoodan Movement or the sacrifice of the land-offering movement of Acharya Vinoba Bhave in India as a marvellous one. It seems almost a miracle to many.

Acharya Vinoba and many of his followers go about walking and appealing to the landed people to part with a portion of their land to the landless in the village. The call goes and many respond immediately, both the rich and the poor.

THE SARVODAYA SAMAJ & THE SARVA SEVA SANGH

The Sarvodaya Samaj and the Sarva Seva Sangh are the two institutions that came into existence, immediately after Gandhiji's demise, at a conference of his followers in Sevagram in April 1948. The Samaj and the Sangh were considered to be the fittest memorials to carry on the message of Gandhiji's life and work. The Samaj represents the Sarvodaya concept and the Sangh is the executive body to implement the programme that may be considered at the annual conferences of the Sarvodaya Samaj.

It was at the annual conferences of the Sarvodaya Samaj at Banaras in 1952 that the Sangh decided to

collect 25 lakhs of acres of land by April 1954, through the Bhoodan Yagna.

THE REAL REVOLUTION

There is an uniqueness in this Yagna unknown to history. The world is familiar with violent movements to bring about revolution. But all those were revolutions of the environments only and left the individual man untouched in his heart and mental outlook. The uniqueness of the Bhoodan Yagna is its straight appeal to the heart and conscience of man. It appeals to the inherent goodness in man. This is a social technique never tried till now on a mass scale. It was Mahatma Gandhi who evolved and handled it on a nation-wide basis for the political liberation of India.

After Gandhiji, the problem of economic freedom or economic equality and justice, remained to be solved still. India had discarded the traditional method of violence and used the non-violent method in her struggle for political freedom. How to continue the Gandhian revolution in the economic sphere was the problem.

Now, economic freedom will be airy nothing unless the worker owns the means of production of the essentials of his subsistence. Therefore everyone, who can till, should be made the owner of the land he needs for his existence. Gandhiji had, of course, the land problem always in his mind. He hoped and said that

the Zamindars would one day give away their lands voluntarily to the landless. Some thought that it may be easy and satisfied themselves with resolutions passed in conferences.

TRANSFORMATION OF HEART AND MIND

But the total transformation of the human heart and mental revolutions cannot be brought about by mere resolutions and appeals. It requires a man who is fully charged with spiritual life, as appeals from him alone can serve as a lever for such revolutions.

It was given to Acharya Vinoba Bhave to take a lead in this problem. He was deeply absorbed in the land problem and in finding a non-violent solution to it. He was as if spiritually qualifying himself for extending the Gandhian revolution in the economic sphere, when the call comes.

THE ORIGIN OF BHOODAN

He had been making various experiments for years in his Ashram at Paunar, 6 miles from Wardha. All were directed to the one object of liberating man from the clutches of money and making him live independently on his own labour. When invited to the Sarvodaya Conference in 1951, consistent with his principle, he walked the distance to Hyderabad of about 350 miles. On his return to Wardha he walked, without the military protection which the Government offered, into the

heart of Telengana area which, you know, was the victim of popular violence on one side and the police methods of putting it down on the other. He walked into this area carrying the message to all—the message of peace, love and unbending courage.

Somewhere in his walk an incident happened which threw a ray of light for Vinobaji. It was in Pochampalli village*. After his usual talk at the meeting, some Harijans said that they were tillers of the soil but had no land of their own to till. Vinobaji paused and thought that there should be someone in the audience who could satisfy the hunger of the landless in their own midst. He appealed to the audience and one Ramachandra Rao immediately came forward offering 100 acres of land. The needy Harijans were satisfied.

To the people there this might have appeared as a miraculous incident of momentary importance. But to Vinoba this was more than that. To him this seemed to convey a guidance from God. If one man could be moved by the need of the landless, why not all those who have, be also moved to give away to the millions of the needy? His faith in God and in human goodness made him hope to tap this invisible perennial resource in every human heart. From the very next day he began to pursue the Bhoodan Yagna—the new way that God had indicated to him to move forward in the footsteps of his great master.

* On 18th April 1951

His mastery of this technique and marvellous use with an exposition of the basic philosophy behind Bhoodan have produced remarkable results. All those who were then sceptical have accepted it now as the only way open to us to deal with the land problem. Persons of all parties except, of course, those who have no faith in human goodness have begun to give their full support to this great Yagna. The State Governments are giving their support to the movement by making the necessary legislation for facilitating the voluntary transfer and distribution of land as well as by offering any available State land to the Bhoodan movement.

THE CULTURAL HERITAGE OF INDIA

To the outside world this is almost impossible to believe. But it is daily happening in India today. It is but natural and consistent with the spiritual and cultural heritage and genius of India that those who have land readily offer a portion to the landless when someone could touch their heart. Gandhiji had already tilled and ploughed the Indian soil during the last thirty years for such a non-violent action. We first reaped the harvest of political freedom. It only required another great man to plough again and sow the seed for the harvest of the economic freedom of the masses. Here was Vinobaji who gave the lead at the proper time.

This Bhoodan Yagna is but the logical outcome of the Sarvodaya philosophy and approach. Gandhiji's philo-

sophy and technique of action were based on the perennial philosophy of truth and non-violence.

THE MAGICAL WORD SARVODAYA

The Sarvodaya Samaj was formed, as I told you, as the fittest memorial to Gandhiji. This magical word 'Sarvodaya' was coined by Gandhiji himself. Sarvodaya means the total welfare of all, to the exclusion of none. This will be possible only by purity of means and a way and value of life based on truth and non-violence.

BHOODAN—A FIRST STEP FOR THE NEW ORDER

The Bhoodan Yagna, therefore, aims at a total transformation of man by change of his heart and mind. Bhoodan is not an end in itself but a key to the solution of the other economic problems with a view to create a new order of society, free from any kind of exploitation of man by man, in all spheres of life—economic, social and political.

(*A Radio Talk at Colombo on 25-6-1953 with
Courtesy to THE RADIO CEYLON*)



APPEAL TO STUDENTS

To Work for Bhoodan Yagna

JAIPRAKASH NARAIN

A DISTRESSING STATE

NOW-A-DAYS, generally speaking, my experience is that the students of the colleges and high schools are attracted towards either socialism or communism or communalism or movements based on communal ideologies as of the Rashtriya Swayam Sevak Sangh or towards the Dravidian Youth League of South India etc. I have seen this happen in my youth during the years 1921—22. At that time the Gandhian tempest raged over the country and the youths were all swept off their feet. But now-a-days the youths are of opinion that the ways of Gandhiji are old-fashioned. They say that Gandhiji's ways cannot appeal to them in this age of the atom bomb, and of revolutionary Russia and China. Perhaps the youths assembled here think differently and have been influenced by Sarvodaya.

I would prefer not to say anything regarding the leaders of communism and communalism, but I would have my say regarding socialism. I have been asked whether I have been able to reconcile Sarvodaya and Socialism in my own mind. This question arises before those of the socialist persuasion, as for instance, the students.

PURE SOCIALISM IS TRUE SARVODAYA

If you understand the aims of Socialism, forgetting its theories for the moment, and bestow some serious thought on its aims alone, it would not be difficult for you to understand how we can very easily make both Sarvodaya and Socialism meet together. What we desire is the establishment of a society in which there will be no exploitation, there will be perfect equality and each individual will have equal opportunities for development. So the question of attaining these ends, and realising these aims arises. We have seen that wherever attempts were made to achieve these aims through violent means, these aims were not realised, exploitation was not removed, equality was not established and the individual did not gain full opportunities for development.

Wherever a new order was brought about through a violent revolution we see an entirely new thing taking shape. Very often what we desire is to destroy the present established order of things and imagine that thereby we are bringing in the new order. The Socialists think that no sooner had we destroyed capitalism than the new order will get established. But in this they are mistaken. Socialism is not a negative thing. Take for instance nationalisation which is a plank of Socialism. Nationalisation alone will not bring in the Socialistic order. We have seen this in our own country and in other countries as well. Leave alone the case of Russia; our Railways today belong to

all, they are no longer the possession of a company, but they are the property of the entire nation. But if we are to say that the Railway administration is free from exploitation we would be mistaken. True, there is no capitalism now; neither is there Socialism. What is ruling there is bureaucracy. Similarly if we say that by nationalising the other industries we will be ushering in Socialism we would only be deceiving ourselves. How then are we to get at the reality? How to proceed so far? We are now faced with this question. But Sarvodaya has already taken long strides in the direction in which we are proceeding, in which our thinking is taking us. Therefore if we are true Socialists we would be true followers of Sarvodaya as well.

VINOBA HAS OPENED THE SARVODAYA WAY

We say that every individual has got the right to take part in the governance of the country. Answering a query as to how true democracy can be established, Vinoba has declared that it is essential to establish village government. And if we are true socialists we should also proclaim our faith in village autonomy. Thus are the two streams of thought meeting together. While some people make fun of my attendance at this conference, my participation in it and my admiration for Vinobaji, there are others who say, "so you have come round at last!" But the time has come now for all of us to think truthfully, deeply and courageously. Any true socialist who strives day and night for realising his aims, will find himself in the same position that I find myself in today.

Let us take into account Gandhiji and Vinobaji. All the others belong to a different category. There was a time when none was able to say how to proceed and where. The common people were then under the expectation that the close followers of Gandhiji would show the way to transform society which Gandhiji would of course have done, had he been alive. But after his exit, the entire prospect was one of utter darkness. My own impression is, had not Vinobaji launched the Bhoodan Yagna campaign we would have forgotten Gandhiji and forgotten Sarvodaya; we would have lost faith in what Gandhiji had said and done and the path of Sarvodaya would have been blocked. Vinobaji has infused new life by placing the Bhoodan Yagna programme before us. Otherwise the constructive workers would have continued ploughing their lonely furrows. This would have certainly benefited the country to some extent but the hope of the common man that the followers of Gandhiji would take steps for the transformation of the country, would have been shattered and an armed revolution would have ensued with entirely different consequences. Therefore we should take to this method in order to achieve the aims we cherish. Let us, forgetting our self-importance and the prestige of the party, get down to work.

SARVODAYA IN THE PLACE OF SOCIALISM

I place all these things before the students purposely because they are all faced with the same question and they are in a dilemma. It seems to them that we are going astray. We should very sincerely keep our aims before our eyes and achieve them. The aims we have,

are not our sole monopoly ; they are claimed by others also ; but our means are different. So Shankarrao Deoji said just now and he is right. If the aim is to establish a society which will be free from exploitation and if that is achieved through violent means the aim will still remain unrealised. Violence sets in motion new forms of exploitation. Exploitation signifies the denial to one of his rights. We cannot expect the complete removal of exploitation. Even today the level of our own life is far higher than that of our brethren ; so it cannot be denied that we have exploited them. You are today engaged in your studies ; much money is being spent on you. Such expense cannot be incurred by the poor over the education of their children. So a part of the responsibility for the exploitation rests on you. Perhaps to hope for the complete removal of exploitation is to hope for the impossible. But we should pursue that ideal and have our limits defined. Even in Russia differences do exist ; the high-paid drawing forty times as much as the low-paid. The level of life lived by the officials is very high ; so exploitation is far from being extinct there. Because they gained power through violence, by the same means they decide the share of the fruits of labour that should go to each. The society which is truly free from exploitation can be created only through non-violence. Hence I have no objection in replacing the name of Socialism by the name Sarvodaya.

TRUSTEESHIP IN ACTION

I have been questioned regarding trusteeship. When Gandhiji went to U. P. in 1935, the Zamindars of the place met him and asked him what their fate would be

under the rule of the Congress-Socialist party which had just then been formed. Gandhiji replied "I cannot prophesy what will happen when the Socialists would have gained dominance over the Congress; but I will not be a party to your extinction so long as you conduct yourselves as trustees of your lands".

I was really put out when I heard this and told my colleagues that Gandhiji was telling this to those very Zamindars who were committing so many atrocities on the poor. He wanted them to become trustees and assured them that he would not allow their removal. The meaning of all this is, neither are they going to become trustees nor would Gandhiji allow their destruction. We believed in those days that this ideal of trusteeship would remain only on paper; it would never be acted upon. But today I am seeing in Gaya where a *bhiga* of land is worth between two to six thousand rupees, people have given their lands. Some 48 thousand acres have been given away. Regarding Gandhiji's pet theories, Kishorlal Bhai once wrote:

"We are mistaken in thinking that the ideals he is expounding are never going to be practised. It appears to us, that Gandhiji may exhort the wealthy to become trustees; but (if the wealthy were not wise) they are not going to do any such thing. The social set-up and its poverty will continue as they are. But if we view Gandhiji in this light, we will be committing a big blunder".

Were he alive today he would himself have taken up the work that Vinoba has undertaken. What is more probable is, he would have done it much earlier and his manner of doing it would have been more attractive. Gandhiji was saying, that we welcome those who

would behave as trustees; if they will not we will prepare the poor and ask them not to cooperate in self-exploitation. Thus will we prepare both. Similarly in the Bhoodan Yagna both the donor and the beneficiary are being prepared. To the extent that Bhoodan Yagna gets popularised, the exploited in the villages will be awakened and they would begin to think of opposing exploitation through non-violent means. So if we simply brush aside the trusteeship idea on the plea that nobody is going to act up to it we would be committing a great blunder. After all, do not even the socialists think of conflicts and class-wars? The working people are not armed with pistols or bombs; when they think in terms of general strikes which according to their belief will make the castle of capitalism topple down, a certain amount of violence is unavoidable in the process.

REVOLUTION HAS COME

When I see the young people today I am reminded of those days when I was studying in the Patna College. At that time Maulana Abul Kalam Azad had come to Patna and I heard his non-co-operation speech. His speech made us all leave our college. The revolution that took place in the mind of the youths then was not due to any other cause in the same measure as to Gandhiji's movement. A similar revolution is in the offing today. I have not till now heard a speech comparable with the one* that Vinoba delivered yesterday. He presented the matter before us as he

* Vinobaji's speech on 7-3-'53 is as it were a

'Sarvodaya Manifesto' (published in SARVODAYA)

viewed it from the philosophical stand-point. Whoever has grasped its significance is sure to have his life transformed. I am having some contacts with the youths and their present condition makes me depressed. They have enthusiasm, but it appears to me that they are lacking in faith, concentration and mental depth.

If the seeds of Sarvodaya have fallen in your mind and intellect, you will remove these defects and you will remember your duty by the performance of which yourself and the society to which you belong will be equally benefited. Vinoba has said that even if you are not to join the Bhoodan Movement, you should leave your colleges. It is impossible that a scholar of his stature to have become an enemy of learning. Why then did he say this? Because the kind of education that is being given today is beneficial neither to the student nor to the society nor again to the country. Such is the present condition. So no effort should be spared towards the realisation of our duty to the maximum extent.

GIVE AN YEAR TO THIS MOVEMENT

We are living in stirring times comparable to 1921. Revolution is afoot. Let us take our share in it. Let us prepare ourselves for it. I want you all to give up your studies; go and wander about in the villages and make what contributions you can to the Bhoodan Movement and try to make this revolution a success.

AN YEAR'S EDUCATION MORE

Why hesitate to leave college for a year? I have seen in America many students studying for a

term and working during the next for earning the means for further studies. I had then become a convert to communism and having decided on a trip to Russia I had left college and was in search of a job which would fetch me enough to make the trip. But those were days of depression and unemployment was on the increase. I wandered continuously, was prepared for any odd job, but I could not secure any. Then I fell ill, incurred some debt in consequence, but cleared it all later by working. On looking back from this distance it does not appear to me that I lost anything by losing a year at the college. I have never felt that what I learnt in fields and factories was inferior or negligible instruction. The experiences that I gained there could never have been had in colleges. Similarly the education you will receive from the villages can never be got from schools and colleges. And I believe that if your parents are concerned about your future, about the development of your personality they will of their own accord say—"All right, my dear boy, go and work for a year". It is expected of everyone that he dedicates himself to Bhoodan Yagna for a year. People are giving away their lands and let us give our time and energy. Vinoba says what a revolution it would be, a revolution that would set an example to the whole world if we succeeded in solving the big problem of land through truly democratic method! If we succeed in solving the big problem of land in a big province like Bihar within a year, it will have far-reaching consequences. So we invite you all to join hands in this revolution and hope and trust that the youth of the country will not fail to take to this road.



BHOODAN AND REVOLUTION

J. B. KRIPALANI

FROM its beginning in Hyderabad, the Bhoodan Movement had a fascination for me. From study of history and participation in one revolutionary movement, I saw in it the elements of a comprehensive revolution. I saw in it the possibility of a revival of Gandhiji's ideas and ideals which we have neglected for the past few years. I wrote about the movement in the columns of the Vigil. From the many arguments that I advanced in favour of my thesis I would quote here one only. It is that when a revolutionary movement has once been started, ordinary individuals participating in it perform tasks which were never expected of them. Under the inspiration of a revolutionary urge they work wonders. This can be illustrated both from religious and political history. Christ's followers, ignorant fishermen, could exercise demons, cure the sick, feed the hungry and perform miracles. The Master's grace had descended on them. Ignorant as they were they could hold their own against the cultured and educated of their times. Christ's 'fishermen' became the 'fishers of men'. In Islam, the tribal disciples of the prophet under the impulse of a new idea soon created an empire greater than that of Rome. The semi-civilised people of the desert became the teachers of mankind in philosophy, science and arts.

In the political field, who could have imagined that a Parisian mob hastily formed could under a revolutionary urge storm the Bastille and raze it to the ground! Who

in our own days and in our country, before the advent of Gandhi on the political scene, could have believed that thousands of our countrymen, including boys of school-going age and women of high families, who had never stepped out of their homes, would court the privations and hardship of jail, inspired by the idea of the independence of the country! Who could have believed that where great patriots had defended themselves in courts of law against the charge of sedition, every urchin in the street would fearlessly raise the slogan that British rule was satanic and the spread of disaffection against it was a national Dharma. Such historical instances of the ordinary instruments of revolution rising to high heights could be multiplied.

We witness this phenomenon re-appearing today in the Bhoodan movement. In a country where brother fought brother for a few Kathas of land and where such land disputes resulted in murders, today boys and girls scarcely out of their teens go about and ask and obtain a few acres of land every day. You heard how a young Bhoodan volunteer in Gujerat with his patience and perseverance, induced a zamindar, who would not allow him to enter his house, to part with twenty-five acres of land. In Gujerat, twenty-five acres of land would mean at least a couple of lakhs of rupees. Such examples are there in plenty.

Another point that I would keep before you this evening is that there are in history two kinds of revolutions. One seeks to change the life of the individual and community in most of its major departments. Another begins with one major department and then proceeds to transform the whole of life.

Buddha and Christ sought to solve the riddle of life. Their mission was purely spiritual. But because their approach to the spiritual problem of the individual was revolutionary, they ultimately succeeded in bringing about comprehensive revolutions. In the wake of the spiritual impulse given by the master, new arts, sciences and systems of philosophy grew up. The political map of the world was changed and new kingdoms and empires were established. Starting from a change in spiritual values the great religions of the world brought about basic changes in other fields of life and activity.

The Bhoodan movement starts with revolutionary ideas about property in land. Yet if it remains at that level it will fail to accomplish even its limited purpose. The movement, if it is truly revolutionary must expand itself to cover all major activities of life. If the landless get a few acres of land and there are a few toddy shops in their midst, their land will evaporate in a few years. If again in spite of land the cultivators were extravagant in their expenditure on birth, marriage, death, etc. and made themselves victims of the rapacious money-lenders, their land would soon disappear. If the village lacks some main and subsidiary industries to provide employment to increasing population, the holdings will be so sub-divided that ultimately they will be of little use to the peasants. Again if the villagers are divided by caste barriers and untouchability, the possession of a few acres of land will scarcely improve their lot. If the Government is bad and tyrannical, corrupt and inefficient, the mere possession of a few acres of land will solve no problems of the villager. If the administration is extravagant and the burden of taxation goes on increas-

ing or if through wrong policies there is inflation the villager will be ruined in spite of his five acres. In short, if the reformer wants the villager really to enjoy the fruits of his newly-acquired land, he must not confine himself merely to the land problem but also tackle the allied social and political problems. In India, before British Raj there were few landless labourers. Almost every villager had a small plot of land. How did these plots disappear? They disappeared because the social and the political arrangements were inimical to their retention. If Bhoodan is to succeed it must work out the whole political, social and economic programme of Bapu.

Today we saw a great step being taken in the movement. Shri Jayaprakash Narayan has announced his 'Jeevandan' for Bhoodan. When he announced his resolve, I too felt tempted to follow his noble example. But a little self-analysis deterred me from taking such a weighty decision. I am known to be prone to anger. I thought if I dedicated my angry self to the movement it may do more harm than good. Only people with some self-control (Samyam) should dedicate their lives for a noble cause. If we suffer from greed, anger, passion, ambition and jealousy, our dedication will be of no avail. Sacrifice to be of value must be pure and without blemish. With the call that Sri Jayaprakash Narayan has given today I hope there will be a re-dedication to the cause.

(From a Speech at Bodh-Gaya on 18-4-1954)



SAMPATTI-DAN OR MONEY-GIFT

SRIKRISHNADAS JAJU

MONEY is a necessity, but it can create evils as well. It should be made a source of the highest service. The principle behind the *Sampatti-Dan-Yagna* is the same as that behind Bhoodan. As land cannot belong to any individual, the same is the case with wealth. It should be for the benefit of the society, which includes the interest of the individual.

SOCIETY—THE SOURCE OF ALL WEALTH

As land should remain with the person who is prepared to labour on it, similarly productive labour should be the source of man's livelihood. Though the constitution recognises individual property, it is our belief that the wealth of all sorts, whether bodily, educational, monetary or of any other type, does not belong to any single person. For example, the education which a person received was not the result of his effort alone. He acquired it through the institutions of the society. Moreover, the knowledge which is acquired through these institutions is itself a result of the efforts of thousands of years. It means that our education is more due to the society than it is due to our own efforts. Therefore, education should be used in the interests of the society to the greatest extent. It needs no argument that wealth should be used for the society, for its source of production is labour.

LABOUR AS THE BASIS OF LIFE

What should be the source of our livelihood? All things are produced with the help of human labour.

Therefore, it should be the source of livelihood. The intellect which hates bodily exertion is an enemy. If a person becomes educated, he thinks it to be his right to get better remunerations. It is wrong to claim a higher remuneration only on the basis of higher education. Without labour intellect alone cannot feed us. Living only on intellect creates inequalities and exploitation. Firstly, there should be no individual ownership; secondly, bodily labour should be the source of livelihood; and, thirdly, a part of the earnings should be given to *Sampatti-Dan*. It is preferable to give a part of the income, but if it is not possible, a part of family expenditure should be given. A sixth part of the net income or a fifth part of the expenditure should be donated. The expenditure should include that on marriages and on children's education. This part to be donated should be changeable with a change in income or expenditure, as the case may be. The promise of *Sampatti-Dan* should be for the whole life. If in the beginning that is not possible, it should be at least for five years.

HOW TO SPEND SAMPATTI-DAN

As to the purpose of expenditure of the wealth received in *Sampatti-Dan*, seeds and ploughs will have to be given to those who are given land; the literature of Sarva Seva Sangh will have to be taken to the common man. The expenditure should be incurred on different items by the giver himself and he should send the account to Acharya Vinoba or the Sarva Seva Sangh.



THE BASIS OF SARVODAYA

R. R. DIWAKAR

THE conception of Sarvodaya (good and progress of all) is a corollary of the doctrine of Satya and Ahimsa. Sarvodaya is a social conception. It is not a word connoting merely individual salvation. It means and includes the good of all, the progress and development of everyone constituting society. It is entirely inclusive and not exclusive, even of the worst and most wicked that may be found in society. It is a positive conception embracing the whole human family and binding it by ties of love which are far stronger and nobler than even those of blood.

‘Live and let live’ is a very common expression which means mutual tolerance in the extreme. But Sarvodaya is a step ahead and it would add, ‘Live and help live’. The right to live is supreme in Sarvodaya, and it is the right of every one. But a right does not and cannot exist without a corresponding obligation on somebody. A right can be exercised only vis-a-vis somebody who has the obligation to respect it, protect it and to see that it is exercised without let or hindrance. Thus accommodation for others, toleration of different points of view and ideologies is the very basis of Sarvodaya. And Sarvodaya comprehends all activities, economic, social and political. One can say that it extends to all planes of existence, namely, physical, vital, mental, moral and spiritual.

It is obvious that in a society based on the principles of Sarvodaya there is a moral obligation on each

individual to respect the other's rights and to see that everyone else has full scope to live, to express and to develop himself. It is grounded in the belief that all can develop and have full scope to develop in this wide world of ours.

Now there is possibility of aggression by those who do not hold this belief. Such aggression may range from disrespect for the rights of others to an attempt to eliminate and destroy the opponents. In such cases, Sarvodaya would recommend the sovereign remedy of Satyagraha. In fact, if truth and non-violence is a Siamese twin that Gandhian ideology has brought to the fore, Sarvodaya and Satyagraha constitute another twin that is inseparable. Satyagraha would resist all aggression, of whatever kind, by adhering to truth and by suffering and non-violence.

Looked at from another point of view and in terms of the society in which we live today, Sarvodaya means the initiation and establishment of a classless and casteless society by truthful and non-violent means.

Class-society is one based on economic, political, social and other inequalities. These inequalities give rise to iniquities through exploitation of 'haves' by 'have-nots'. All exploitation means taking undue advantage of one's own superiority and strength in some respect, with a view to some gain, personal or group. Such conduct is morally unjustifiable and wrongful. Moreover, exploitation is not restricted only to the field of economics and politics but it is found even in the spiritual field!



ALL INDIA BHOODAN

RECEIVED AND DISTRIBUTED TILL 10th DECEMBER 1954

Province	Land received in acres	No. of Dan-patras	Land distributed in acres	No. of families
1. Bihar ..	21,27,268	2,41,712	1,616	944
2. Uttar Pradesh ..	5,16,819	15,258	65,997	22,262
3. Rajasthan ..	3,25,374	2,192	5,842	1,364
4. Hyderabad ..	1,03,706	3,815	21,027	4,559
5. Utkal ..	1,15,207	38,397	708	214
6. Madhya Pradesh ..	80,481	13,639	7,638	1,724
7. Madhya Bharath ..	62,412	5,377	..	..
8. Saurashtra ..	41,000	15,000	..	..
9. Gujarat ..	36,170	7,760	942	251
10. Tamil Nad ..	28,259	4,774	316	115
11. Andhra ..	20,361	672	..	..
12. Kerala ..	28,032	1,200	..	..
13. Maharashtra ..	15,480	769	..	..
14. Punjab ..	10,143	3,008	..	..
15. Delhi ..	9,245	249	58	22
16. Vindya Pradesh ..	5,656	1,050	331	150
17. Mysore ..	4,390	1,875	..	..
18. Bengal ..	6,889	2,631	254	171
19. Himachal Pradesh ..	1,900	66	..	..
20. Karnatak ..	2,180	239	239	..
21. Assam ..	1,692	..	..	..
22. Bombay ..	123	6	..	..
	35,42,787	3,59,689	1,04,968	31,776

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Bhoodan Yagna

By Bandhudas Sen 0 4 0

Earth is the Lord's

By Marjorie Sykes 0 8 0

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